

ATUL POHANKAR

AUTOMATION & PROCESS EXCELLENCE LEADER | FINANCE SHARED SERVICES | F&A TRANSFORMATION | SIX SIGMA | AGILE

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Accomplished transformation and process excellence leader with 20+ years of experience across consulting, Finance Shared Services/BPO, technology, automation and operational improvement, including 14 years of Finance Shared Services/BPO experience. Hands-on exposure to R2R, P2P and O2C, budgeting, financial modelling and profitability planning, with strong capability in F&A consulting, current-state assessment, process-gap and opportunity analysis, solution design, ERP enhancement and transformation. Experienced in assessing current-state processes, identifying gaps/opportunities, creating opportunity charts for AP/AR/R2R, developing recommendations and solutions, and supporting implementation. Delivered large-scale finance transformation across multi-region environments, including 2,000+ Finance SSC automations and 100+ Root Cause Analyses. Brings practical experience with GenAI/AI reporting and SAP agent development, combined with Six Sigma, Agile, Lean, stakeholder management and change leadership.

LEAN SIX SIGMA & PROCESS EXCELLENCE HIGHLIGHTS

- Managed and coordinated 8 Lean Six Sigma White Belt and Yellow Belt programmes, with an average batch size of 12 participants per programme.
- Conducted Lean Six Sigma capability-building sessions through the Opportunity Hopper programme twice annually, including programme-launch and six-month follow-up sessions.
- Facilitated Root Cause Analysis (RCA) sessions and designed Gemba Walk projects to identify process gaps, waste and improvement opportunities.
- Organised and facilitated a 2017 Process Engineering Community Operational Meet, involving stakeholders across Europe and the US from 8 Shared Service Centres, driving cross-location problem solving and best-practice sharing.
- Delivered process improvement, automation and reporting initiatives contributing to significant productivity and cost benefits, including approximately 18–22 FTE productivity benefits.
- Developed MIS and Excel VBA-based F&A reporting tools supporting reporting visibility and process efficiency.

CORE SKILLS

R2R (Record-to-Report) • P2P (Procure-to-Pay) • O2C (Order-to-Cash) • Budgeting & Forecasting • Financial Modelling • Profitability Analysis • F&A Consulting • Finance Shared Services / BPO • Current-State / Future-State Assessment • Opportunity / GAP Analysis • Process Transformation • ERP Transformation • ERP Enhancement • Finance Process Automation • RPA • GenAI / AI Reporting • SAP Agent Development • Root Cause Analysis • Six Sigma • Lean / Kaizen • Agile / Scrum • Value Stream Mapping • Change Management • Risk Analysis • Stakeholder Management • Strategic Thinking • Problem Solving • Excel VBA • Coaching & Team Leadership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Knowledge Life Consulting Services | Consulting Manager | Pune | 08/2024

- Advised on business strategy and implementation with a focus on translating business objectives into actionable improvement initiatives.
- Assessed current-state processes to identify process gaps, pain points and improvement opportunities across finance and business operations.
- Created opportunity charts for AP, AR and R2R, developed recommendations and solution options, and supported implementation planning and execution.
- Applied process-gap/opportunity assessment, solution design and change-management practices to improve business objective achievement.
- Designed coaching and organizational development programs and supported strategic change initiatives.

Fujitsu Consulting India | Business Service Manager | Pune | 11/2021 – 08/2024

- Improved operational efficiency by 60% and reduced compliance risk by stabilizing license-management processes and tools.
- Led OEM coordination, customer partnerships, transitions, stakeholder management and project Go-Live activities.
- Contributed to QADEx project consulting and auditing and created the SIBPS organizational roadmap.

Johnson Controls | Senior Manager | Pune | 11/2018 – 11/2021

- Implemented continuous-improvement strategies across 4 regions covering finance processes including AP, AR and R2R for IBC Shared Service Centers.
- Managed and coordinated 8 Lean Six Sigma White Belt and Yellow Belt programmes, including participant planning and programme coordination, with an average batch size of 12 participants.

- Conducted Lean Six Sigma capability-building sessions through the Opportunity Hopper programme twice annually, including an initial session at programme launch and a follow-up session after six months to identify and progress improvement opportunities.
- Facilitated structured Root Cause Analysis (RCA) sessions for process issues, enabling teams to identify root causes and implement sustainable corrective actions.
- Led Lean, Six Sigma and structured problem-solving training for teams.
- Created and maintained MIS/reporting solutions, including an Excel VBA-based F&A reporting tool, improving reporting visibility and management information.
- Led ERP enhancement initiatives through successful completion, aligning process requirements with system improvements.
- Assessed automation risks and opportunities during new transitions and identified RPA/process-automation opportunities for Finance Shared Service Centers.
- Designed supervisory-level control solutions and introduced Gemba Walks and visual workplaces for daily management.

Vodafone Pvt. Ltd | Lead Transformation | Pune | 05/2011 – 11/2018

- Successfully implemented 2,000+ process automation initiatives and 100+ structured RCA initiatives across Finance Shared Services, identifying productivity, quality and process-efficiency improvement opportunities.
- Developed and implemented continuous-improvement strategies across India, APAC, EMEA and North America, driving standardisation and process optimisation across global operations.
- Organised and facilitated a Process Engineering Community Operational Meet (2017) involving stakeholders across Europe and the US from 8 Shared Service Centres, bringing teams together to identify and resolve cross-shared-service process issues, share best practices and drive cost/productivity improvements.
- Identified and implemented improvement opportunities across Shared Services, including eService tools and process solutions, contributing to approximately 18–22 FTE productivity benefits.
- Facilitated structured RCA, process-improvement and problem-solving sessions to address operational issues and improve process performance.
- Created MIS and management reporting solutions, including Excel VBA-based tools for F&A reporting and performance visibility.

Mphasis | Sr. Technical Support Officer | Pune | 01/2008 – 05/2011

- Provided technical support and solutions within an IT services environment.

Trust Systems & Software (I) Pvt. Ltd | IT Solution Provider | Nagpur | 08/2006 – 07/2007

- Delivered IT solutions and services for client requirements.

Soft Dev Solutions | Software Developer & AutoCAD Drafting | Nagpur | 07/2001 – 12/2005

- Software development and AutoCAD drafting for tailored client solutions.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 2,000+ Finance Shared Service Center process automations across AP, AR and R2R.
- 100+ Root Cause Analyses supporting finance-process improvement and transformation.
- Multi-region F&A transformation experience across India, APAC, EMEA and North America.
- Finance Shared Services/BPO experience spanning 14 years, with hands-on R2R/P2P/O2C exposure.
- ERP enhancement and transformation initiatives, including finance-process and automation opportunity assessment.
- Current-state assessment, GAP/opportunity analysis, solution design and implementation support for AP/AR/R2R.

CERTIFICATIONS

- ISO 9001:2015 QMS Implementation & Internal Auditor
- Six Sigma Black Belt
- Certified SAFe® 5 Practitioner
- Scrum Master

EDUCATION

Dharampeth Science College, Nagpur | B.Sc. in Information Technology | 12/2001 – 03/2005

Bombay Technical Board, Nagpur | Diploma in Computer Technology | 08/1998 – 08/2001